

# SANDEEP BAZAR

## Senior Engineering Manager | Platform Engineering, Kubernetes & Applied AI

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### SUMMARY

Engineering manager with 14 years at IBM India Systems and Development Lab, now running several squads on hybrid-cloud platform infrastructure: virtualization, hosted control planes, multicluster management and observability. Builds teams from the first hire through to production adoption, stays close to the architecture, and spent four years owning round-the-clock escalations for global enterprise deployments. Six granted US patents. Executive PhD in progress at IIM Udaipur. Also owns agentic AI for the platform: where an agent helps, how it reaches production safely, and the tooling behind it.

### SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built the Virtualization and Multicluster squads from the first hire through to production adoption.
- Founding member of IBM's Modern Data Protection team in Pune. It began with around 20 engineers and is past 50 today.
- Six granted US patents, two IBM Redbooks, an IEEE paper and an OpenStack Summit talk.
- Own agentic AI for the platform: where agents help, how they reach production systems safely, and the tooling behind it.

### CORE SKILLS

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Leadership</b>         | Building and scaling teams   Hiring and career development   Technical vision and roadmap   Distributed, matrixed organizations                                   |
| <b>Platforms</b>          | Kubernetes and OpenShift   KubeVirt and hosted control planes   Open Cluster Management   Docker                                                                  |
| <b>Storage &amp; data</b> | IBM Fusion   IBM Storage Scale   OpenStack Swift   NFS, SMB, object   Backup and recovery                                                                         |
| <b>Applied AI</b>         | Agentic system design   Agent guardrails, approval and audit   AI-assisted diagnostics and operations   LLM application and evaluation patterns   MCP, watsonx.ai |
| <b>Engineering</b>        | Go, Python, C/C++, Java, Linux   Prometheus, Loki, Elasticsearch   Jenkins, Git, Docker                                                                           |

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### Senior Development Manager - IBM Storage Fusion

Sep 2022 - Present

*IBM India Systems and Development Lab*

*Pune, India*

Promoted from Senior Technical Lead.

- Lead engineering across virtualization, hosted control planes, multicluster management and observability in IBM Fusion.
- Own agentic AI for the platform. Decide where an agent helps, design how it reaches production systems safely, and build the tooling in Go.
- Built the Virtualization and Multicluster squads from scratch, from hiring and technical direction through to the first production deployments.
- Own priorities, roadmap and production readiness for enterprise hybrid-cloud infrastructure.
- Run goal-setting, reviews and development plans across several squads.
- Led the architecture of the observability framework and built it in Go on Prometheus, Loki and Elasticsearch. Improved several existing platform microservices.
- Lab advocate for large enterprise accounts, so field problems reach engineering as prioritized work.
- Drive AI-assisted diagnostics and platform-operations work to improve serviceability.

#### Technical Lead - Storage Scale, Data Protection & Escalation Engineering

Feb 2016 - Aug 2022

*IBM India Systems and Development Lab*

*Pune, India*

- Founding member of IBM's Modern Data Protection team in Pune. Set up hiring, onboarding and the lab; it started with around 20 engineers and is past 50 today.
- Led IBM Storage Scale Object on OpenStack Swift across RHEL and Ubuntu, owning design, review and the Jenkins build and release pipeline.
- Four years as the Asia-Pacific escalation engineer for Spectrum Scale on a 24/7 rota, working CritSits directly with global customers.
- Wrote diagnostic tooling that cut the time it took to isolate distributed-storage failures.
- Co-authored two IBM Redbooks. Mentored engineers into test, build and lead roles.

#### Software Engineer - Storage, Security & Cloud Platforms

Oct 2012 - Jan 2016

*IBM India Systems and Development Lab*

*Pune, India*

- Owned quality engineering and automation for SONAS, V7000 Unified and Spectrum Scale.
- Led authentication and security certification across Active Directory, LDAP, NIS and OpenStack Keystone, and qualified the NFS, SMB, object and SNIA CDMI stacks.
- Ran continuous integration and fix propagation across several concurrent release streams.
- Wrote Java and Python tools for object storage and storage-utilization reporting.

## Software Engineering Intern

Sep 2011 - Sep 2012

*IBM India Systems and Development Lab*

*Pune, India*

- Built a cloud storage and sync service for SONAS and V7000 Unified in Java on SNIA CDMI. It won the IBM Innovation Showcase and became an IEEE paper.
- Wrote a log-analysis tool in PHP and MySQL that support engineers used to cut down debugging time.

## EDUCATION

### Executive PhD, Operations Management (in progress)

Jul 2025 - Jun 2028

*Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Udaipur*

Research area: artificial intelligence and technology management.

### M.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

2010 - 2012

*KIIT University, Bhubaneswar*

CGPA 9.39. AICTE GATE Scholarship, two years.

### B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

2006 - 2010

*Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University*

## PATENTS – SIX GRANTED, UNITED STATES

- Dynamic control of a smart home using a wearable device - US 10072866, US 10250403, US 9473321
- Controlling implantable medical devices using wearable technology - US 10226632
- Identifying and managing redundant digital content transfers - US 10419557
- Overriding feature to unblock contacts in energy-saving mode - US 9965024

## PUBLICATIONS, TALKS & OPEN SOURCE

- IBM Redbook - IBM Spectrum Scale Security (REDP-5426), 2018
- IBM Redbook - Deployment Guide for IBM Spectrum Scale Unified File and Object Storage (REDP-5113), 2017
- IEEE - Enterprise Compatible Cloud Object Storage and Synchronization Service, 2012
- OpenStack Summit, Tokyo - Mobilize Platform Agnostic Adaptability for Object Store, 2015
- IBM Community - Bringing Agentic AI to IBM Fusion Fleet, 2026
- Medium - article series on IBM Fusion, Kubernetes MCP and agentic operations, 2026
- IBM Storage Strategy Days and IBM user-group sessions - customer-facing technical presentations
- ibm-fusion-mcp-server - maintainer. Fork of the open-source Kubernetes MCP server (Go), extended with IBM Fusion tools.
- ocm-mcp-server - author. Puts policy checks, approval and audit between an AI agent and a Kubernetes fleet, so the agent never holds credentials.
- ai-roadmap-365 - author. Open-source nine-course AI curriculum, from computing fundamentals to designing, evaluating, securing and deploying production AI systems. 141 of 365 lessons published.

## AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Winner, IBM Innovation Showcase (2012), for a cloud object storage and sync prototype on SNIA CDMI
  - IBM Execution Excellence and Eminence (2017); IBM Collaborative Influence (2017)
  - IBM Team Excellence (2018); IBM New IBMer (2013); Star of the Month, several times
- CompTIA Storage+ (SNIA) | IBM watsonx.ai Technical Essentials | IBM License to Lead, First-Line Manager | IBM Agile Explorer

Endurance and ultra runner, including 300+ km single-stage events.